02 PRIVATE ESTATES

Private estates

A considered overview of property fundamentals, ownership, stewardship, and ongoing costs.

THE INVESTMENT LENS

A private estate is a property asset whose character, use, condition, and obligations are shaped by its location and legal framework. Historic, rural, residential, or mixed-use properties can each have distinct ownership structures and operating needs. A review starts with the property itself—not an assumption of appreciation, rental income, or ease of resale.

Considerations

- Establish what is included: land, dwellings, outbuildings, fixtures, access, and any operating or recreational rights.
- Check ownership, boundaries, permitted uses, occupancy, leases, easements, covenants, and transfer restrictions.
- Assess building condition, deferred maintenance, historic-preservation obligations, staffing, insurance, and annual running costs.
- Consider whether the intended ownership and management arrangements suit the property's scale, local taxes, and applicable law.

Risks to understand

- Illiquidity, uncertain resale timing, concentration in one property, and costs associated with a complex sale.
- Unexpected repairs, renovations, specialist maintenance, staffing, utilities, insurance, and local taxes.
- Restrictions on alteration, access, use, development, conservation, tenancy, or transfer.
- Exposure to severe weather, wildfire, flood, subsidence, environmental hazards, or changes in local regulation.

BEFORE CONSIDERING AN OPPORTUNITY

Start with the questions that matter.

01 Does independent legal review confirm clean title, complete boundaries, lawful access, and all registered or customary property rights?

02 Have qualified building, structural, environmental, and specialist property inspections identified defects and quantified remedial work?

03 What are the verified ongoing costs, tax exposure, insurance limits and exclusions, and practical management requirements?

04 Are there conservation, heritage, planning, occupancy, lease, or transfer restrictions that affect the proposed use or ownership?

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